EU Payment Processor Fees Comparison 2026

Research Brief | Online Card Payments | EUR 2,000 Monthly Volume
Date: October 2026 | Market: EU (Ireland pricing pages used)

Executive Summary

Scenario: Small EU online shop processing EUR 2,000/month in 40 card payments of EUR 50 each (EU consumer cards)

Cheapest option: PayPal Advanced Card at EUR 38.00/month (requires approval)

Second: Stripe at EUR 40.00/month

Third: Mollie at EUR 46.00/month

Most expensive: PayPal standard checkout at EUR 82.00/month for commercial transactions

Note: SumUp's online payment rates were not clearly stated on their pricing page; in-person rates are 1.69% (EUR 33.80/month on EUR 2,000)

Important: Real costs depend on card type (consumer, premium, business) and country of card issuance. Rates shown are for standard European Economic Area consumer cards only.

Monthly Cost Comparison Table

Calculation for 40 payments of EUR 50 each = EUR 2,000 total monthly volume

Provider	Transaction Fee	Monthly Fee	Total Monthly Cost	Formula
PayPal (Advanced Card*)	**1.20% + €0.35**	**€0**	**€38.00**	**(€2,000 × 1.20%) + (40 × €0.35) = €24.00 + €14.00**
Stripe	1.5% + €0.25	€0	**€40.00**	(€2,000 × 1.5%) + (40 × €0.25) = €30.00 + €10.00
Mollie	1.80% + €0.25	€0	**€46.00**	(€2,000 × 1.80%) + (40 × €0.25) = €36.00 + €10.00
PayPal (Standard checkout)	3.40% + €0.35	€0	**€82.00**	(€2,000 × 3.40%) + (40 × €0.35) = €68.00 + €14.00
SumUp	*Online: not found In-person: 1.69%*	€0 or €19	*Not calculated***	In-person only: (€2,000 × 1.69%) = €33.80

*PayPal Advanced Credit and Debit Card Payments requires application and approval

**SumUp's online payment fee structure was not clearly stated on their Irish pricing page

Hidden Fees Breakdown

Provider	Monthly Fee	Payout Fee	Currency Conversion	Chargeback Fee
Stripe	€0	€0 (standard) +1% instant	+2% if required	€20
PayPal	€0	No fee (no conversion)	3.00% above base rate	€16 (chargeback) €14 (dispute)
SumUp	€0 (standard) €19 (Payments Plus)	€0	*not found*	€10
Mollie	€0	First 5/month: €0 After 5: €0.25 each***	1% of payout amount	*not found*

***Payout fee applies only to accounts processing less than €500,000/year

Detailed Findings by Provider

Stripe

- **Transaction fee:** 1.50% + €0.25 for standard EEA consumer cards
- **Premium EEA cards:** 2.80% + €0.25
- **UK cards:** 2.50% + €0.25
- **International cards:** 3.15% + €0.25
- **Monthly fee:** €0
- **Payout fee:** Standard payouts free; instant payouts add 1%
- **Currency conversion:** +2% if required
- **Chargeback fee:** €20 per dispute
- **Country:** Ireland (IE) pricing page

Source: https://stripe.com/ie/pricing (accessed with JavaScript enabled to view full pricing details)
Chargeback fee: https://www.bubblehub.ie/blog/card-payment-fees-ireland

PayPal

- **Standard commercial transaction fee:** 3.40% + €0.35 (PayPal checkout)
- **Advanced Credit and Debit Card Payments:** 1.20% + €0.35 (Blended Pricing; requires application and approval)
- **Alternative Payment Method (APM):** 1.20% + €0.35
- **Monthly fee:** €0
- **Payout fee:** No fee for standard bank withdrawals when no currency conversion is involved
- **Currency conversion:** 3.00% above base exchange rate
- **Chargeback fee:** €16.00 (for chargeback on credit/debit card transactions)
- **Dispute fee:** €14.00 (standard dispute fee)
- **Country:** Ireland (IE) pricing page

Source: https://www.paypal.com/ie/business/paypal-business-fees

SumUp

- **In-person transaction fee:** 1.69% (pay-as-you-go) or 0.95% (Payments Plus)
- **Online transaction fee:** not found on pricing page
- **Monthly fee:** €0 (standard plan) or €19 (Payments Plus)
- **Payout fee:** €0 (money in Business Account by next day)
- **Currency conversion:** not found
- **Chargeback fee:** €10
- **Country:** Ireland (IE) pricing page
- **Note:** SumUp's pricing page primarily focuses on in-person payments; online payment rates were not explicitly stated

Source: https://www.sumup.com/en-ie/pricing/
Chargeback fee: SumUp Support

Mollie

- **Transaction fee:** 1.80% + €0.25 for EEA consumer cards (Visa/Mastercard)
- **EEA commercial cards:** 2.90% + €0.25
- **Non-EEA cards:** 3.25% + €0.25
- **Monthly fee:** €0
- **Payout fee:** Up to 5 payouts per month free; €0.25 per additional payout (for accounts processing less than €500,000/year)
- **Currency conversion:** 1% of payout amount when payout currency differs from primary balance currency
- **Chargeback fee:** not found (dispute fees page was inaccessible)
- **Country:** General EU pricing (no country-specific page specified)

Source: https://www.mollie.com/pricing

Key Observations

Winner by Scenario

- **Lowest transaction fees:** PayPal Advanced Card at €38.00/month (requires approval)
- **Second lowest:** Stripe at €40.00/month (for standard EEA consumer cards)
- **Third lowest:** Mollie at €46.00/month
- **Most expensive:** PayPal standard checkout at €82.00/month (2.16× more than PayPal Advanced)
- **Best for in-person:** SumUp Payments Plus at 0.95% (€19.00 + €19/month = €38.00 total)

Hidden Fee Highlights

- **Chargeback fees vary widely:** €10 (SumUp) to €20 (Stripe)
- **Currency conversion is expensive:** PayPal charges 3% above base rate; Mollie charges 1% on payouts; Stripe charges +2%
- **Payout frequency matters for Mollie:** More than 5 payouts/month incurs €0.25 per payout
- **No monthly fees across the board:** All providers offer €0 monthly fee options (except SumUp's optional Payments Plus upgrade)
- **PayPal has two pricing tiers:** Advanced Card option (1.20% + €0.35) requires separate application and approval

Card Type Matters

- **Stripe premium EEA cards:** 2.80% + €0.25 (87% higher than consumer cards)
- **Mollie commercial cards:** 2.90% + €0.25 (61% higher than consumer cards)
- **UK cards cost more:** Stripe charges 2.50% + €0.25 (67% higher than EEA consumer)
- **International cards highest:** Stripe 3.15% + €0.25; Mollie 3.25% + €0.25

Data Limitations

- SumUp's online payment fee structure was not clearly stated on their Ireland pricing page
- Mollie's chargeback/dispute fee information was not accessible
- SumUp's currency conversion rate was not found on their pricing page

Methodology

All data collected from official provider pricing pages accessed in October 2026. Ireland-specific pricing pages were used where available (Stripe IE, PayPal IE, SumUp IE). Mollie pricing appears to be general EU pricing. Stripe's full pricing details were accessed with JavaScript enabled. Currency conversion and chargeback fees were cross-referenced with support pages and third-party research where official pricing pages did not provide complete information.

Disclaimer: Fees are subject to change. Always verify current rates on each provider's official pricing page before making a decision. This brief is for informational purposes only and does not constitute financial advice.